Let A_1, B_1, C_1 .... be the cofactors of a_1, b_1, c_1 ... in $|A|$.

Hence, the cofactor determinant is $|A| = a_1A_1 + b_1B_1 + c_1C_1$ $\begin{vmatrix} A_1 & B_1 & C_1 \\ A_2 & B_2 & C_2 \\ A_3 & B_3 & C_3 \end{vmatrix}$

Similarly, $|A| = a_2A_2 + b_2B_2 + c_2C_2$ and $|A| = a_3A_3 + b_3B_3 + c_3C_3$

Note that the sum of the product of elements of any row (or column) with their corresponding cofactors is the value of the determinant.

$$\text{Now } a_1A_2 + b_1B_2 + c_1C_2 = -a_1\begin{vmatrix} b_1 & c_1 \\ b_3 & c_3 \end{vmatrix} + b_1\begin{vmatrix} a_1 & c_1 \\ a_3 & c_3 \end{vmatrix} - c_1\begin{vmatrix} a_1 & b_1 \\ a_3 & b_3 \end{vmatrix}$$

$$= -a_1(b_1c_3 - b_3c_1) + b_1(a_1c_3 - a_3c_1) - c_1(a_1b_3 - a_3b_1)$$

$$= a_1b_1c_3 + a_1b_3c_1 + a_1b_1c_3 - a_3b_1c_1 - a_1b_3c_1 + a_3b_1c_1 = 0$$

Similarly we get

$$a_1A_3 + b_1B_3 + c_1C_3 = 0 \;;\; a_2A_1 + b_2B_1 + c_2C_1 = 0 \;;$$

$$a_2A_3 + b_2B_3 + c_2C_3 = 0 \;;\; a_3A_1 + b_3B_1 + c_3C_1 = 0 \text{ and } a_3A_2 + b_3B_2 + c_3C_2 = 0.$$

Note 7.12

If elements of a row (or column) are multiplied with corresponding cofactors of any other row (or column) then their sum is zero.

Example 7.31

If A_i, B_i, C_i are the cofactors of a_i, b_i, c_i, respectively, $i = 1$ to 3 in

$$|A| = \begin{vmatrix} a_1 & b_1 & c_1 \\ a_2 & b_2 & c_2 \\ a_3 & b_3 & c_3 \end{vmatrix}, \text{ show that } \begin{vmatrix} A_1 & B_1 & C_1 \\ A_2 & B_2 & C_2 \\ A_3 & B_3 & C_3 \end{vmatrix} = |A|^2 .$$

Solution

Consider the product $\begin{vmatrix} a_1 & b_1 & c_1 \\ a_2 & b_2 & c_2 \\ a_3 & b_3 & c_3 \end{vmatrix} \begin{vmatrix} A_1 & B_1 & C_1 \\ A_2 & B_2 & C_2 \\ A_3 & B_3 & C_3 \end{vmatrix}$

$$= \begin{vmatrix} a_1A_1 + b_1B_1 + c_1C_1 & a_1A_2 + b_1B_2 + c_1C_2 & a_1A_3 + b_1B_3 + c_1C_3 \\ a_2A_1 + b_2B_1 + c_2C_1 & a_2A_2 + b_2B_2 + c_2C_2 & a_2A_3 + b_2B_3 + c_2C_3 \\ a_3A_1 + b_3B_1 + c_3C_1 & a_3A_2 + b_3B_2 + c_3C_2 & a_3A_3 + b_3B_3 + c_3C_3 \end{vmatrix}$$

$$= \begin{vmatrix} |A| & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & |A| & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & |A| \end{vmatrix} = |A|^3$$

That is, $|A| \times \begin{vmatrix} A_1 & B_1 & C_1 \\ A_2 & B_2 & C_2 \\ A_3 & B_3 & C_3 \end{vmatrix} = |A|^3$.

$$\Rightarrow \begin{vmatrix} A_1 & B_1 & C_1 \\ A_2 & B_2 & C_2 \\ A_3 & B_3 & C_3 \end{vmatrix} = |A|^2 .$$

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